

STEP-BY-STEP
PLAYBOOK

How to Build a High-Impact Strategy

A practical, no-fluff framework for building strategies that actually get executed — from clarity and alignment to measurable outcomes.

 45 min read  Teams & Leaders  8 Slides

TYPE	AUDIENCE	EDITION
Strategy Framework	Mid-Market Leaders	2026

THE CHALLENGE

Why most strategies never leave the **slide deck**

Only

9%

of organizations fully achieve their strategic goals each year.

The gap isn't intelligence or ambition. It's the absence of a repeatable system for turning intention into action — and action into outcomes.

"A strategy without execution is just a wish list."

No Clear Direction



Teams pull in different directions because the strategy was never truly communicated or understood.



Death by Planning



Months spent in workshops and decks — with no execution. Strategy becomes a shelf document.



Metrics Don't Move

Activity is high, outcomes are flat. There's no connection between daily work and strategic goals.



Stakeholder Misalignment

Leadership says one thing, managers hear another, teams do a third. Alignment is assumed, never built.



This guide addresses each of these failure modes with a structured, repeatable playbook. →

What you'll walk away with

GUIDE STRUCTURE

02 The Challenge

03 What You'll Learn

04 The Framework

05 Step-by-Step

06 Tools & Resources

07 Common Pitfalls

08 Action Plan

BEFORE YOU START

This guide works best when read with your leadership team. Bring a notebook. Block time to complete the exercises at the end of each section.



01 Diagnose your strategic starting point

Understand where you are today before deciding where to go — and why that order matters.



02 Define a focused, compelling direction

Build a strategy statement your entire organization can recall, repeat, and act on.



03 Translate vision into executable priorities

Convert ambitious goals into quarterly bets, clear owners, and measurable milestones.



04 Align your team around shared commitments

Run alignment sessions that create real buy-in — not just nodding heads in a meeting.



05 Build a review rhythm that keeps it alive

Install a lightweight cadence so your strategy is reviewed, refined, and never abandoned.

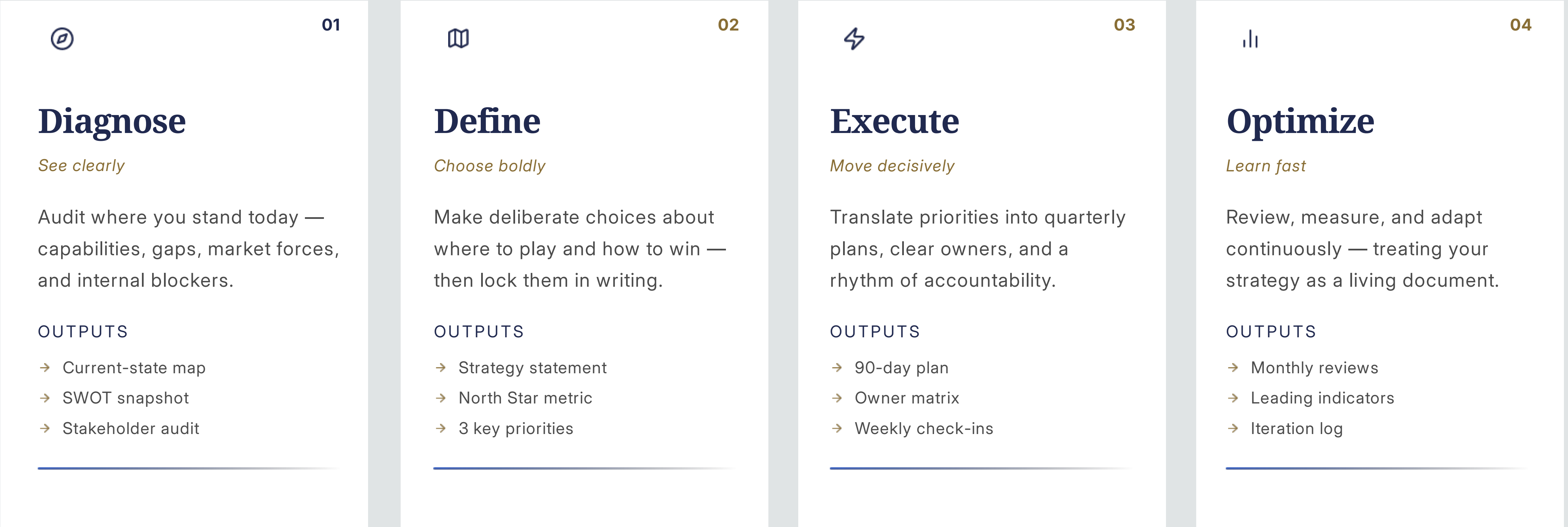


06 Measure what actually matters

Choose 3–5 leading indicators that tell you whether your strategy is working before it's too late.

The 4-stage strategy model

D·D·E·O Framework



The framework is cyclical — after Optimize, you return to Diagnose with new data and greater clarity.

Five steps from insight to execution

01	Run a Strategic Audit Week 1–2 Interview key stakeholders. Analyze your competitive position, revenue mix, and client concentration. Map what's working, what's broken, and what's unclear.	»	YOUR ACTION Conduct 5–8 leadership interviews using the provided question framework.
02	Write Your Strategy Statement Week 3 In one paragraph, define: who you serve, the problem you solve, how you solve it differently, and what winning looks like. Test it for clarity — not eloquence.	»	YOUR ACTION Complete the Strategy Canvas template. Share with 3 internal critics.
03	Set Your 3 Strategic Priorities Week 4 Identify the three bets that will move the needle most in the next 12 months. Say no to everything else. Priorities only work if they're actually prioritized.	»	YOUR ACTION Run a priority-ranking session with your leadership team using the trade-off matrix.
04	Build Your Execution Rhythm Month 2 Establish a weekly team check-in, a monthly strategy review, and a quarterly planning session. Assign owners, define success metrics, and make accountability visible.	»	YOUR ACTION Launch your first weekly 30-min strategy pulse meeting. Use the provided agenda.
05	Measure, Learn & Adapt Ongoing Track 3–5 leading indicators, not just lagging results. After each quarter, hold a 'What did we learn?' session and update your strategy before the next planning cycle.	»	YOUR ACTION Build your Strategy Dashboard with one leading and one lagging metric per priority.

RESOURCES

Tools & templates included

📄 12 ready-to-use resources

🔍 Research & Diagnosis

Stakeholder Interview Template

15 questions to uncover blind spots

Current-State Canvas

Worksheet

Map capabilities, gaps, and assets

Competitive Positioning Matrix

Framework

See where you sit vs. alternatives

📅 Strategy Design

🌀 Execution & Alignment

90-Day Launch Plan

Template

Week-by-week first quarter roadmap

RACI Ownership Matrix

Worksheet

Assign clear accountability

Weekly Pulse Agenda

Framework

30-minute meeting that actually works

📈 Measurement & Review

Strategy Dashboard Template

Template

5 metrics on one page

Monthly Review Scorecard

Worksheet

Track leading and lagging signals

Quarterly Retro Framework

Framework

Learn fast, adapt faster

All templates are available as editable Google Docs and Notion pages upon enrollment.

WHAT TO
AVOID

Six pitfalls that kill good strategies

✕ **Confusing activity with progress**

Busy teams feel like executing. They're often just maintaining. Track outcomes, not outputs.

✕ **Setting 10+ priorities**

When everything is a priority, nothing is. Three bold bets beat ten safe ones every time.

✕ **Measuring only lagging indicators**

Revenue last quarter tells you what happened. Leading indicators tell you what's about to happen.

✕ **Making strategy by committee**

Too many voices dilute clarity. Strategy needs a final decision-maker — consensus is for tactics.

✕ **Skipping the communication layer**

Writing the strategy is 20% of the job. Getting 100% of your team to understand it is the other 80%.

✕ **Treating the plan as finished**

A strategy that never changes wasn't strategic to begin with. Build in scheduled adaptation cycles.



The Antidotes

Define 'done' before you start — what does success look like, numerically?

Appoint a Strategy Owner with final-call authority on priority conflicts.

Run a 'stop doing' exercise alongside every planning session.

Test comprehension: ask random team members to explain the strategy in their own words.

"The best strategy review is the one that actually happens. Imperfect and regular beats perfect and annual."

Your 90-day action plan

WEEK 1-2

Diagnose

- ☑ Schedule stakeholder interviews
- ☑ Complete competitive audit
- ☑ Gather current revenue & client data
- ☑ Identify top 3 internal blockers

WEEK 3-4

Define

- ☑ Draft your strategy statement
- ☑ Run a leadership alignment session
- ☑ Lock in your 3 strategic priorities
- ☑ Communicate direction company-wide

MONTH 2

Execute

- ☑ Launch 90-day execution plan
- ☑ Assign owners & set milestones
- ☑ Start weekly pulse meetings
- ☑ Begin tracking leading indicators

MONTH 3+

Optimize

- ☑ Run first quarterly strategy review
- ☑ Update priorities based on results
- ☑ Share wins publicly with the team
- ☑ Plan the next 90-day cycle

Ready to get started?

Quinn Growth works alongside leaders to implement this framework in their specific context — not as consultants, but as execution partners.

- Facilitated strategy sessions
- Custom tools & templates
- Ongoing accountability partner

 [Book a Strategy Call](#)

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